



feature

Star Trek

The biggest achievement that this installment of Star Trek hopes to accomplish is breathe some new life into this dying franchise. Face it, trekkies need newer fans to join the ranks, don't they? Well this movie might be precisely that — a new cast to hook newer fans. Set at a time just before the beginning of the original TV series, great care is being taken to ensure the story fits into the Trek canon. We have a young James T. Kirk (not "captain" yet, we think) played by Chris Pine and Spock played by Zachary Quinto, before they unite aboard the USS Enterprise to combat Nero (Eric Bana), a Romulan from the future who threatens the United Federation of Planets. If all of that just confused you you're clearly not a trekkie. But that's OK, just wait till May to get in on the action.

Crank 2

Crank 2 sees Jason Statham reprise his role as the hero Chev Chelios. Wait a minute. This is not a prequel, so how is that possible? Didn't he fall to his death at the end of *Crank*? Turns out he didn't. Having miraculously survived his plummet, Chev now faces a Chinese mobster who has stolen his nearly indestructible heart and replaced it with a battery-powered ticker that requires regular jolts of electricity to keep working. Talk about realistic plots! But really, who cares? If going by *Crank*, which was in a true sense the most stylish, adrenaline-packed movie ever (literally because adrenaline was part of the plot), this new offering shouldn't disappoint. But since you never know how a sequel might go, at least Amy Smart has been thrown in for eye candy.

G.I. Joe: Rise of Cobra

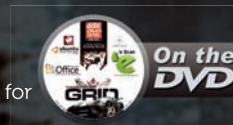
Even in India there should be a fair bit of nostalgia associated with G.I. Joe. Who hasn't played with 'em action figures and who can forget the cartoon? The movie should be a nice action-packed no-brainer for a fun afternoon with your old buddies. Directed by Stephen Sommers of *Mummy* fame, its got a stellar cast which includes Christopher Eccleston and Sienna Miller as well as Sommers' old *Mummy* pals Brendan Fraser and Arnold Vosloo. The story is set around G.I.O.E., an acronym for the Global Integrated Joint Operating Entity, which is an international force of operatives who use high-tech equipment to battle Cobra, an evil organisation headed by a Scottish arms dealer. Still nothing beats the prospect of seeing Snake Eyes and Shadow on the big screen, breaking each others little plastic limbs off. Oh wait, no plastic.

Terminator Salvation

We come in somewhere around 14 years after the events of *Terminator 3: Rise of the Machines*. Christian Bale (John Connor) is now 30 years old, as he leads the resistance against the machines alongside wife Kate (Bryce Dallas Howard). Yup, there is no Schwarzenegger in this one, nor for the series of sequels this movie will spawn. It seems the Governor was too busy to reprise his role, so Roland Kickinger will be the principal Terminator machine out for John Connor's blood. The terminators in this

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one are not going to be the advanced T1000s (liquid metal) or even the T800s, which was the one portrayed by Arnie in T2. The movie features older models, which somehow tie into the story. McG, the film's director, said this on the film's official blog, "there are Hydrobots that patrol the water, Transports that move human prisoners around, Harvesters that collect human beings as lab rats for Skynet and Aerostats that survey all that is going on with the resistance the world over. We've started shooting the T-600 — the bigger, grimmer, nastier version that preceded the T-800. Like Reese says, they're easier to spot but they pack a mini-gun and carry kick ass fire power. They're eight-foot tall killers that prowl the badlands looking for anything with a heartbeat to terminate."

Still, the plot of the movie is not that simple. With the appearance of a stranger, Marcus Wright, John must decide whether he is a friend or a foe. As Skynet, the sentient supercomputer leading the machine army prepares its final assault, Connor and Marcus both embark on a journey that takes them into the heart of Skynet's operations. Here a terrible secret behind the possible annihilation of mankind, awaits them. Dun dun dun...

Fast & Furious

Well we can't say much about this one. It's the fourth installment in a franchise of movies that has spawned quite a few Desi Drag Demons. But whether this will be a worthwhile movie really depends on whether Paul Walker can come up with some more facial expressions or if Vin Diesel can pull off some killer stunts. What's confusing is that this is the fourth movie, but according to the storyline, it's supposed to occupy the third slot. What's that, like a mid-quel? Scheduled for a mid-year release, we hope this one has some nice action sequences to look forward to. Why it deserves a mention here is because the film is touted to be better than the original; more grittier, more "hardcore", and more unpredictable. We'll just have to wait and see for ourselves. ■

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Comedies		
Adventureland A typical Superbad-like account of youthful summer misadventures The Informant Well not really a laugh-out-loud comedy, but a black comedy starring Matt Damon. It's based on a true story about the world of agribusiness price fixing.		
Re-makes		
The Taking of Pelham 123 The 1970s improbable tube train hijack caper redone Birds A remake of Alfred Hitchcock's strangest movie. There's talk of Naomi Watts and George Clooney in the starring roles. Nine Based on Federico Fellini's hugely influential 8½		
Other Picks		
Push Based on the novel by Sapphire A definitely controversial film intended to capture the raw, fierce energy of the book it's based on. The plot deals with the troubled life of a poor black teenager who's pregnant by her own father Brooklyn's Finest Richard Gere, Don Cheadle and Ethan Hawke in a gritty cop movie New Moon - Sequel to Twilight. Keep a lookout late this year.		